



EMOTIONAL INTELLIGENCE
Asking for Help

Asking for Help

4x

People with high levels of resilience are 4 x more likely to ask for help than those with low levels of resilience

88%

% respondents with **high levels** of resilience who are comfortable asking for help

20%

% respondents with **low levels** of resilience who are comfortable asking for help



Asking for Help



What has stopped you from asking for help in the past?



Belief that asking for help is a sign of weakness



Unwilling to expose lack of knowledge, skill or experience



Concerned about surrendering control of a situation or project



Lack the necessary social skills to ask



Pride – the desire to achieve things on their own



Fear of rejection, embarrassment or being a burden



Fear based on past experience when showing vulnerability



Not knowing who to turn to for help



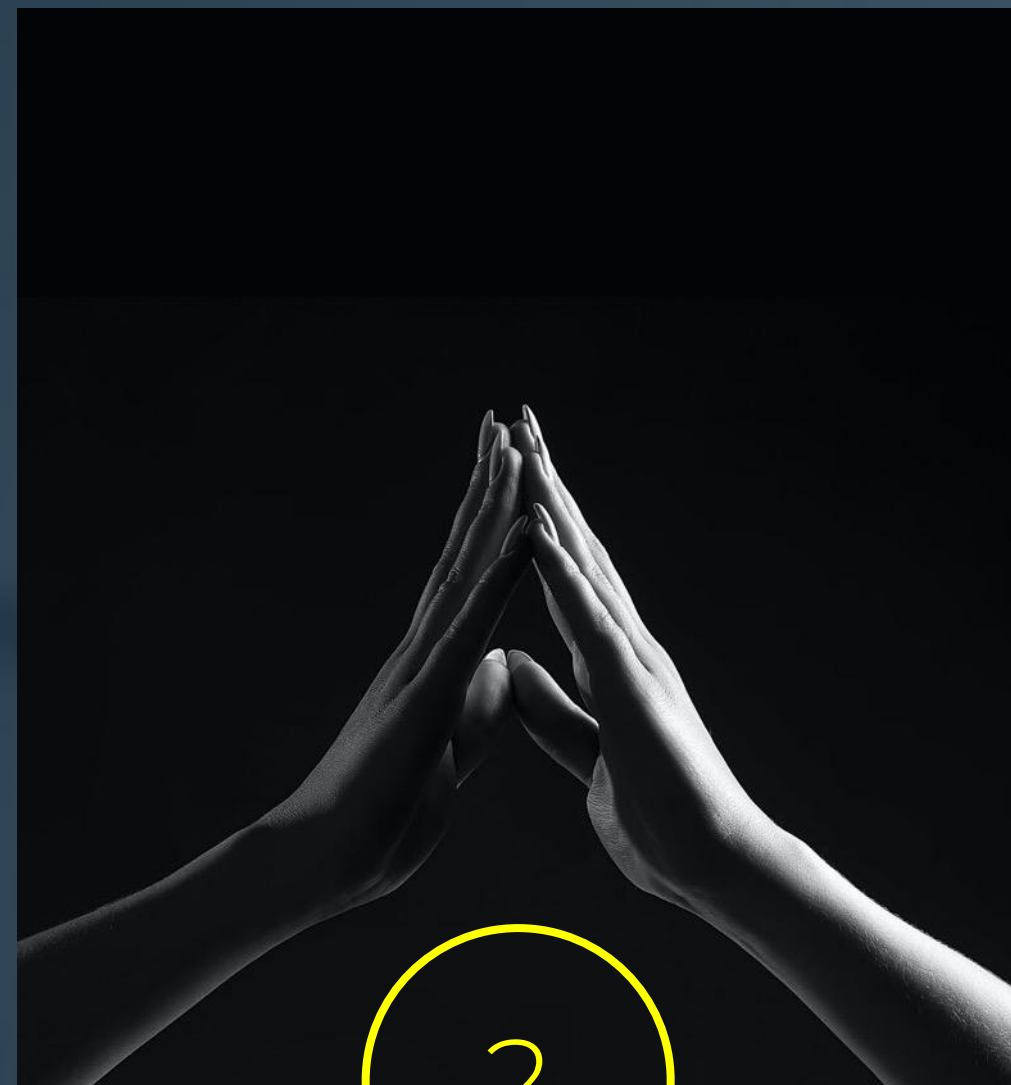
Concern over what someone may want in return

Benefits of Asking For Help



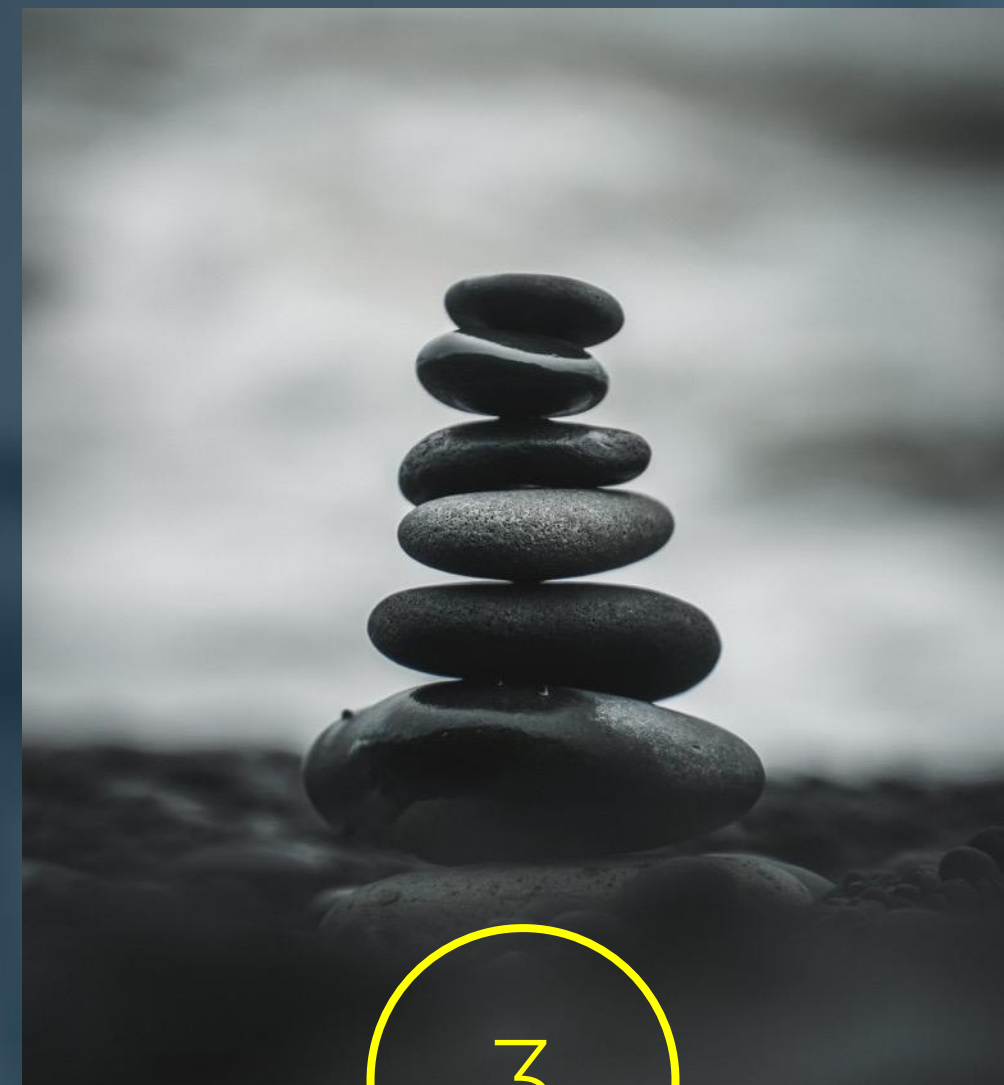
1

Enables you to
move forward
more quickly



2

Connects you
with other people



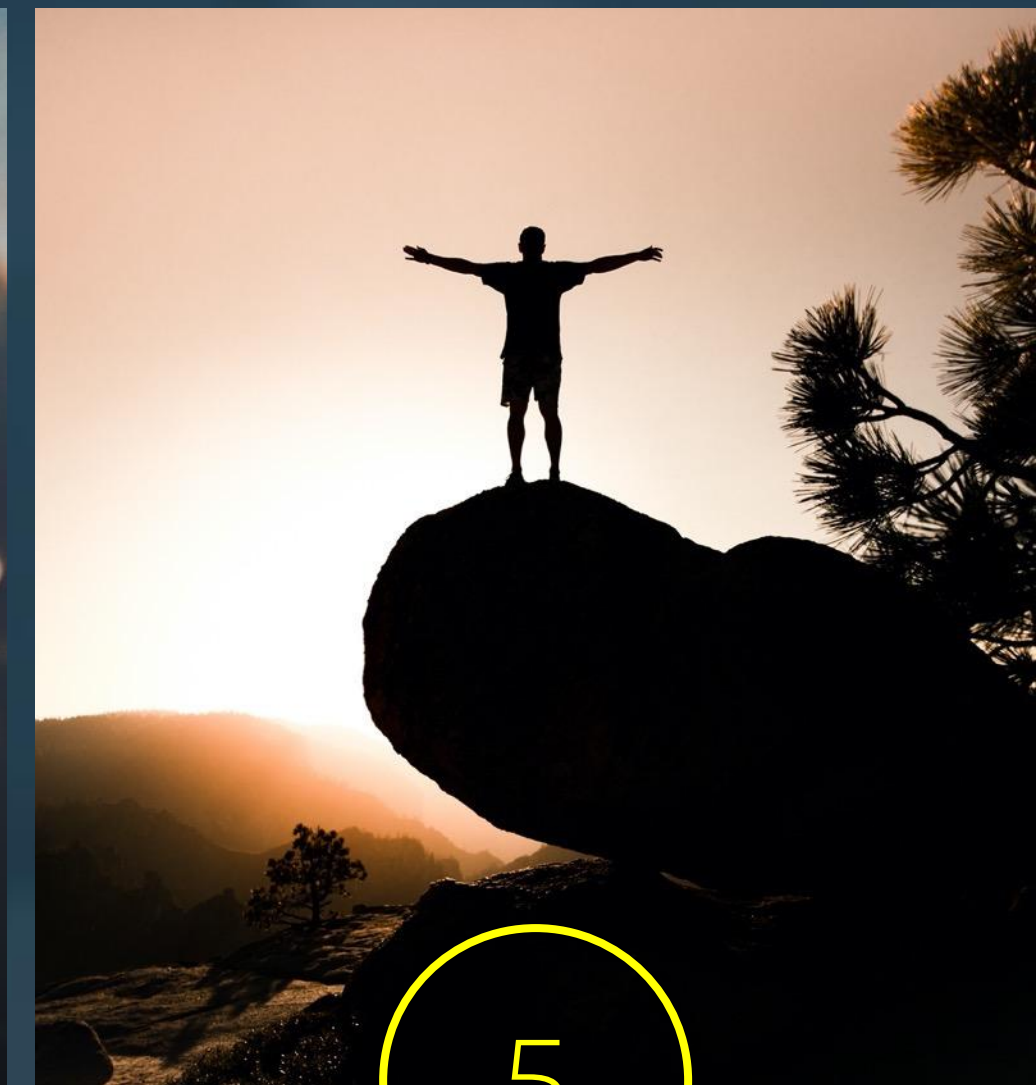
3

Builds trust with
other people



4

Increases your
productivity



5

Increases self-
confidence and
self-efficacy

Asking for Help

Best Practice

‘It’s hard to make progress in modern organisations without assistance from others’



Identify the best person to help you – build and leverage your network.



Be clear and specific about what you are asking for.



Express yourself with confidence preferably face to face rather than via email or text.



Show appreciation for the help you receive.



Assume other people’s good intentions and honesty and believe that they will be open about whether they can help or not.



Offer help in return and to other people.



Remember, generally people like to offer help and support.

Taking The First Step



SCENARIO 1 TEAM MEETING

You are in a team meeting listening to a presentation, when a new concept is explained that you don't fully understand.



Ask a question for clarification.
Chances are, you won't be the only person in the room who didn't understand it the first time around.



SCENARIO 2 PROJECT TEAM

You are working as part of a project team, but your personal role, responsibilities and goals are unclear. This is impacting your productivity and performance and is causing anxiety.



Seek clarification from the project manager and ensure that you have clearly defined roles, responsibilities and goals in writing going forward.



SCENARIO 3 YOUR WELL-BEING

You are working late every evening and also into the weekends, which is having a major impact on your well-being and work/life balance.



Talk to your manager, they may not be aware of the situation and the impact it is having on you.

Asking for Help



EXERCISE 1

Become confident in seeking help: a 6-step process

Learning to ask for help can be challenging. This 6-step process provides a structured approach to overcoming the barriers that prevent you from seeking assistance, fostering personal growth and confidence.

1

Identify the limiting beliefs and assumptions that are holding you back

2

Reflect on the source of the limiting beliefs

3

Experiment with small steps

4

Share with other people

5

Create opportunities for practice and accountability

6

Take a step back and reflect

Asking for Help



EXERCISE 1

Become confident in seeking help: a 6-step process

Learning to ask for help can be challenging. This 6-step process provides a structured approach to overcoming the barriers that prevent you from seeking assistance, fostering personal growth and confidence.

1. Identifying the limiting beliefs

What are you afraid will happen if you ask for help?

What would be the worst possible thing that could happen as a result?

2. Reflect on the source of the limiting beliefs

What is the source of the limiting belief?

What did you experience when you asked for help in the past?

3. What small step could you take?

What specifically are you going to do to ask for help – specify 2 clear actions:

4. Share with others

Who can you confide in about your goal? Consider your manager, mentor, or a colleague. Identify two people with whom you will share this goal, preferably people who you feel comfortable with and from whom you can learn:

5. Create opportunities to practice asking for help

Set specific goals (weekly) around how many requests for help you will make.
My weekly goal is:

Tell your manager or a colleague who can help you create accountability.
My accountability partner is:

6. Step back and reflect (monthly)

Where was I able to ask for help? What made it easier to do this?
Where didn't I ask for help when I really could have used it? What held me back?
Where do I have the opportunity to ask for help next?